

DOCUMENT 6

FUNDING & SPONSORSHIP TARGET STRATEGY

Student Impact Challenge (S.I.C.) — Guide for Identifying and Opening Funding Conversations

CORE RULE

Not every partner should be asked for cash. The fellow should identify which prospects are appropriate funding targets, open the conversation professionally, and hand qualified funding leads to program leadership. The fellow does not negotiate sponsorship amounts, benefits, exclusivity, contracts, or use of logos.

1. Organizations to Approach for Financial Sponsorship

Pri.	Target Type	Examples	Planning Range*	Best Funding Story
A	Banks & Credit Unions	Chase, Capital One, Citi, Bank of America, TD, Bethpage FCU	\$25K–\$100K+	Scholarships, financial literacy, entrepreneurship, economic mobility
A	Corporate Foundations	Bank, insurance, technology and employer foundations	\$10K–\$100K+	Education, youth opportunity, community impact
A	Accounting & Consulting	Deloitte, PwC, EY, KPMG, Accenture	\$15K–\$50K+	Problem-solving, career readiness, financial skills
A	Insurance & Financial Services	New York Life, MetLife, Guardian, AIG	\$10K–\$50K+	Scholarships, financial education, family/community impact
A	Technology & Telecom	Verizon, T-Mobile, Microsoft, Google, Samsung	\$25K–\$100K+ or in-kind	Digital equity, technology, innovation, education
A	Automotive	Toyota, Honda, Hyundai, Kia, Ford	\$25K–\$100K+	Innovation, mobility, STEM, community
A	Healthcare Systems	Northwell, NYU Langone, Mount Sinai	\$10K–\$50K+	Youth/community health, education, local impact
B	Law Firms	Skadden, Paul Weiss, Kirkland, Latham, Davis Polk	\$10K–\$25K+	Education, mentorship, professional exposure, public service
B	Real Estate & Development	Related, RXR, Brookfield, SL Green	\$10K–\$50K+	Community development, neighborhoods, youth opportunity
B	Retail & Major Employers	Target, Macy's, Best Buy and large NY employers	\$10K–\$50K+ or in-kind	Community impact, student opportunity, prizes

*Planning ranges are internal prospecting guidance only, not promises, published prices, or amounts the fellow is authorized to quote. Actual asks should be approved by program leadership after researching the prospect.

2. Proposed Sponsorship Architecture

Level	Illustrative Level	Positioning
Presenting Partner	Up to \$100,000+	Highest-level statewide relationship; naming/presentation rights only if approved and contractually agreed.
Statewide Impact Partner	Around \$50,000	Supports statewide awareness, student opportunity and program delivery.
Scholarship Partner	Around \$25,000	Supports scholarships and educational opportunity.
Community Impact Partner	Around \$15,000	Supports outreach and community participation.
Student Innovation Partner	Around \$10,000	Supports problem-solving, innovation or a defined award category.
Supporting Partner	Around \$5,000	Entry-level corporate support for approved program needs.

These levels are a strategic starting framework. Benefits, recognition, tax language, naming rights, deliverables and valuation must be finalized by program leadership before being offered.

3. Sponsored Award Concepts

A company may respond more strongly to a specific mission-aligned award than to a generic request for money. The following are examples for internal development; company names must never be attached until the company formally agrees.

Award Concept	Best Sponsor Type	Alignment
Financial Empowerment Award	Bank / financial institution	Financial literacy, economic opportunity, entrepreneurship
Future Innovator Award	Automotive / technology	Innovation, problem-solving, STEM
Technology & Community Award	Telecom / technology	Digital solutions and community improvement
Healthy Communities Award	Healthcare / fitness	Health, wellness and community solutions
Neighborhood Impact Award	Real estate / local employer	Solutions improving neighborhoods and local businesses
Young Entrepreneur Award	Consulting / finance / business	Entrepreneurial thinking and business problem-solving

4. Organizations to Approach for VALUE Before Cash

Category	Primary Ask	Why
Radio / TV / Media	Awareness, interviews, PSAs, student stories, community calendars	Media reach may be more valuable than a small cash contribution.
Sports Teams	Tickets, winner experiences, merchandise, recognition, amplification	Create memorable recognition for students and educators.
Footwear / Apparel	Products, winner packages, experiences, youth activation	Expand prize value and student excitement.
Hotels	Event space, rooms, educator/winner experiences	Reduce program costs and create premium experiences.
Airlines / Transportation	Flights, travel, transportation experiences	Support winner experiences and program logistics.
Gyms / Fitness	Memberships, wellness packages, promotion	Wellness benefits and local awareness.
Universities	Scholarships, campus experiences, mentors, judges	Educational value can exceed a standard sponsorship check.

5. First-Wave Funding Targets

Recommended first wave: JPMorgan Chase, Capital One, Citi, Bank of America, TD Bank, Bethpage Federal Credit Union, New York Life, MetLife, Deloitte, PwC, EY, KPMG, Verizon, Toyota and Northwell Health.

The fellow should not assume these organizations will fund the program. Each must be researched for current programs, eligibility, geographic requirements, application processes and the correct decision-maker before outreach.

6. Fellow Funding Outreach Sequence

Research

Confirm the company has a relevant giving, community-impact, sponsorship or foundation pathway.

Qualify

Document why the organization fits the Student Impact Challenge and what it could reasonably support.

Select the Ask

Choose one opening angle: scholarship, statewide impact, innovation award, community impact, or introductory sponsorship conversation.

Open the Conversation

Send the approved short outreach message. Do not lead with a demand for a specific dollar amount unless leadership has approved that prospect-specific ask.

Follow Up

Follow up after 3–5 business days and ask for the appropriate community-impact, foundation or sponsorship contact.

Escalate

When the prospect asks for a sponsorship deck, budget, benefits, meeting, contribution amount, nonprofit documentation or agreement, hand the lead to program leadership.

7. What the Fellow May and May Not Say

Status	Rule
MAY SAY	We are exploring corporate and scholarship partnerships for the Student Impact Challenge.
MAY SAY	More than \$100,000 in scholarships, cash and prizes are available across the initiative.
MAY SAY	I would like to connect you with program leadership to discuss sponsorship opportunities.
MAY SAY	We believe your organization's work in [verified area] aligns with the challenge.
MAY NOT SAY	Your company will receive specific benefits, naming rights, exclusivity or guaranteed media exposure.
MAY NOT SAY	A contribution is tax-deductible in a specific amount or manner without approved tax/legal language.
MAY NOT SAY	A company is an official sponsor or partner before written approval/agreement.
MAY NOT SAY	I can approve a sponsorship amount, contract, benefit package or use of the organization's logo.

8. Qualified Funding Lead — Handoff Checklist

Before handing a lead to program leadership, record: organization; contact name/title; verified contact route; relevant giving/community program; recommended sponsorship angle; what the prospect requested; whether they asked for a deck, budget or meeting; deadline/application date if any; all correspondence; and recommended next action.

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